

DIALOG — Structural Outsourcing Brief

KOR Structural · July 10 2026 meeting · Verified 2026-07-01 — every load-bearing claim independently fact-checked against primary sources; ~60 projects catalogued firm-wide

Claims are [V] verified (primary source) or [H] hypothesis to test in the room. A “Do NOT say” list is at the end. Primary contact: **Georg Josi** — Partner, Structural Engineer, Edmonton Studio Chair (PhD, PEng).

THE ANSWER — what DIALOG outsources structural for, IN EDMONTON [V]

(The commissioning question: “they have a massive structural department but are so busy they outsource — what types of projects, focus on Edmonton?”)

In Edmonton, DIALOG has brought in external structural engineers on **three project types**:

1. **Very large hospitals delivered design-build** — **Kaye Edmonton Clinic (~\$900M): DIALOG + Yolles (now Jacobs) as co-equal structural engineers.** Their own award submission cites the “massive scale and ambitious schedule” as the reason — so the “too busy → outsource” premise is **exactly right for this project type**, and only this one. Below mega-scale they stay in-house (Norwood \$364M, Edson, Grande Prairie ~\$680M).
2. **High-rise residential towers** — **The Parks (45+35 st) → RJC; The Hendrix (27 st) → RJC.** On Edmonton towers the developer typically procures structural separately from architecture; RJC currently owns that lane.
3. **Architecture-only commissions** (client hires structural directly) — **HSBC Place repositioning → ISL + RJC; Brewery District → ISL.** (Mega-venues also go external — *Rogers Place → Thornton Tomasetti prime, DIALOG associate — but under HOK, not DIALOG’s choice.*)

They do NOT outsource in Edmonton: standard-scale hospitals, civic/cultural (Royal Alberta Museum, Winspear), **bridges & transit (strongest in-house domain** — Walterdale, Valley Line), airport buildings, rec centres, own office towers (Enbridge Centre).

The July-10 implication: the realistic lane is the **Kaye-model mega-hospital co-SE** (“who do you reach for next time?”) plus **overflow capacity** — their Edmonton structural partner bench has thinned (Montgomery → emeritus, S. Renihan → transit) while the RPK merger added healthcare workload. The rest of this brief is the firm-wide evidence, the people, and how to run the meeting.

Firm-wide pattern — what DIALOG outsources structural engineering for

DIALOG self-performs the bulk of its structural with a deep multidisciplinary bench. External (or co-) structural engineers appear in **five recurring situations** [V]:

1. **Tower work, where the developer procures structural separately from architecture.** On high-rises, DIALOG plays *either* the architect role *or* the consulting-SE role — almost never both. As architect/AOR (usually under a design lead): Vancouver House (BIG → Glotman Simpson + BuroHappold), Brookfield Place 60st (AFK → Entuitive), The Parks (Hariri Pontarini → RJC), The Hendrix (→ RJC). As SE-only: the ex-Jones Kwong Kishi practice (merged into DIALOG **Oct 2013**) engineered Shangri-La Vancouver/Toronto (62/65st), Fairmont Pacific Rim, Shaw Tower — **for other architects (James KM Cheng)**, not as DIALOG-prime. The only verified DIALOG-prime-with-in-house-structural building is **Enbridge Centre (26st)**.
2. **A design/“star” architect leads a civic/cultural project and DIALOG is executive/AOR:** Calgary Central Library (Snøhetta → Entuitive), TELUS Spark (Kasian → Stantec).
3. **Alberta mega-hospital design-builds led by PCL** → co-SE, n=2: Kaye Edmonton Clinic ~\$900M (→ Yolles/now Jacobs, *equal partners*) and Calgary Cancer Centre \$1.4B (→ DIALOG + Stantec). **This is NOT a general scale rule:** UHN Toronto Western (~\$1B, CM delivery) is fully in-house — the co-SE pattern is tied to the AB design-build consortium structure, not project size. Extrapolating it to other provinces/GCs is [H].
4. **Specialist structural innovation they lack in-house** → pioneer seismic mass timber (Fast+Epp, The Hive), rammed earth (Equilibrium, Nk’Mip), life-sciences labs (Blackwell, Catalyst-77 Wade), forensic concrete (RJC, Glenbow), blast/security (Thornton Tomasetti, Peel Police).
5. **A studio lacking the relevant specialty** → Vancouver’s structural practice (ex-JKK towers, Broadway Subway, community/housing) has **no healthcare structural track record**; Ottawa (opened 2026) has zero structural partners. *Caveat: a gap does not force outsourcing* — DIALOG cross-deployed Hildenbrandt from Calgary to do Dartmouth General (NS) in-house.

Self-performs (do NOT pitch): transit/bridges (their strongest domain — Walterdale, Valley Line, Broadway Subway, airports), sports/rec, mid-rise full-suite buildings when prime (Enbridge 26st), standard CLT timber (Bill Fisch), own civic (Royal Alberta Museum, Winspear), and **home-market healthcare at any scale outside AB design-build** (Grande Prairie ~\$680M, Edson, UHN Toronto Western ~\$1B, Markdale, Dartmouth).

One line for the room: “DIALOG brings in external structural where the developer or a design-lead architect procures it separately, on Alberta mega design-build hospitals as a co-SE, for specialist innovation, and where a studio lacks the specialty — and self-performs transit, bridges, mid-rise, civic, and most healthcare in-house.”

Strategic read for July 10 — a relationship meeting, not a seat pitch

There is no verified open seat to pitch. Triggers 1–2 are **developer/design-lead decisions** — **not DIALOG’s to award**; trigger 3 is rare (next AB mega-DB hospital is years out); trigger 5 belongs to other studios. What Georg Josi can give KOR: **(a)** a specialist/overflow relationship with Edmonton (their AB partner-level structural capacity genuinely is contracting), **(b)** an intro path into the next AB mega design-build co-SE, **(c)** a referral into the BC studio, **(d)** the Misericordia watch. Walk in to become *the firm they think of* — not to ask for a seat that isn’t on the table.

- **UHNBC Acute Care Tower (\$1.579B, Prince George)** [V facts, H opportunity]: DIALOG+EllisDon alliance (formed Dec 2025), design through late 2026, construction ~2027, opening ~2031. **Structural is most likely inside DIALOG BC’s own scope** — the alliance named separate mechanical (PML) and electrical (Houle) participants precisely because DIALOG doesn’t self-perform those, and named **no structural participant**; their BC entity is legally “DIALOG BC Architecture **Engineering** Interior Design Planning Inc.” (Contrast: on the Cowichan Hospital alliance, architect Parkin — no in-house SE — named Bush Bohlman as a structural participant.) **Probe as capacity support, never claim the seat is open:** “Is your BC team self-performing structural on UHNBC, or would a BC healthcare-structural partner help carry it?” Note: **Prince George is low-seismicity** (PGA ≈0.07g — Edmonton-level, 6–9× below Vancouver) — do not pitch it as seismic-intensive; the post-disaster importance angle is what applies.
- **Misericordia inpatient tower** (~350 beds, architect seat open, planning-only funding) — long-lead AB teaming watch. (*Event Park & NAIT: likely self-performed or Thornton Tomasetti — probe, not pitch.*)

DIALOG structural bench — who owns what [V]

- **Edmonton (largest studio, ~150 staff post-RPK):** Georg Josi (Studio Chair; healthcare — Kaye), **Steven Oosterhof** (PhD/PE/SE — **voting member of the NBCC Standing Committee on Earthquake Design** (chaired by Perry Adebar, UBC); venue/commercial), Neil Robson (bridges/transit), Steven Prozniak (bridges), Ryan Renihan/Larissa Ulcar/Victoria Buffam (assoc). Jim Montgomery → Partner Emeritus 2025; Sandra Renihan → transit PM. **AB partner-level structural capacity is contracting.**
- **Calgary:** Ralph Hildenbrandt (**healthcare lead** — GP Regional, Calgary Cancer, Dartmouth), Chris Lenzin (Studio Chair), Gerry Carson (precast/UHPC).
- **Toronto:** Daria Khachi (healthcare + forensics/post-disaster), Cameron Ritchie (healthcare), Charles Marshall (Studio Chair).
- **Vancouver:** Thomas Wu (towers — ex-JKK credits incl. Shangri-La/Pacific Rim), Mehrak Razavi, Fadi Ghorayeb — plus Broadway Subway/community work; **no healthcare structural track record.**

Firm context (for the relationship) [V]

Partner-owned (50+ partners, flat governance, no single CEO), **600+ staff, 6 studios** (Vancouver, Calgary, Edmonton, Toronto, Ottawa [2026], San Francisco), fully multidisciplinary. **B Corp**, AIA-2030 + **SE 2050** carbon commitments, “Community Wellbeing Framework” (with the Conference Board of Canada) is core identity. Chair **Antonio Gómez-Palacio** (since 2022). *Fast Company* Most Innovative Architecture Firms 2026 (Peter Loughheed Wildlife Overpass). Deeply fluent in **IPD / alliance / design-build** (UHNBC alliance, Calgary Cancer DB, Broadway Subway DBF).

How KOR should position

- **Language:** “integrated team,” “all disciplines at the table,” “co-creative from concept” — **never “sub-consultant.”** Speak partner, not vendor.
- **Respect their code authority:** Oosterhof sits on the national seismic-code committee. **Do not lecture them on NBC content.** KOR’s value is the *delivered bench*: decades of post-disaster/high-importance structural practice in Canada’s highest seismic-hazard zones, plus capacity — “you have the code table; we have the coastal-BC production depth behind it.”
- **The seismic wedge (exact wording — checked against the code, safe in front of the committee members in the room):** “Since May 1 2024, Alberta designs to the NBC 2023 Alberta Edition, which for the first time brings Alberta post-disaster buildings under Article 4.1.8.23 — the NBC 2020 requirement that hospitals behave essentially elastically under a more frequent earthquake, with a tightened 0.5% interstorey drift limit and minimum $R_d \geq 2.0$. The 1.5 importance factor isn’t new — that’s been there since the 1990s — but this performance check is new to Alberta, and it’s the kind of requirement coastal-BC practices have been designing around for years.”
- **Values hook:** frame seismic resilience as **community wellbeing**, and **bring an embodied-carbon/LCA story** — a B-Corp, SE-2050 firm will expect it.
- **The precedent to name:** “the Fast+Epp-on-The-Hive model — a specialist structural partner brought in co-creatively” — for specialist/overflow scope, wherever it arises.

Competitors for DIALOG's external structural work [V]

- **RJC Engineers** — the heavyweight: towers-with-co-arch, education, museum renovation, YYC airport; AB healthcare (South Health Campus). The one to displace.
- **Entuitive** — Edmonton office since 2016; Brookfield Place + Calgary Library. Institutional, **no AB acute-care record** (don't overstate).
- **Glotman Simpson / BuroHappold** — Vancouver developer/starchitect towers. **Fast+Epp** — mass timber (entrenched; don't contest). **Stantec / Jacobs** — the AB mega-hospital co-SE incumbents. **Bush Bohlman** — took the structural-participant seat on the Cowichan Hospital alliance (the BC-health-alliance precedent).

Do NOT say (fact-checked — these would get corrected in the room)

1. **Don't cite Shangri-La as "DIALOG self-performing structural as prime architect"** — DIALOG was never the architect (James KM Cheng was); the structural is a **Jones Kwong Kishi legacy credit** (merged Oct 2013, after completion). Their people know their own history. Only prime+in-house case: Enbridge Centre, 26st.
2. Don't say "DIALOG outsources hospital structural" broadly — they self-perform at ~\$680M (GP Regional) and ~\$1B (UHN Toronto Western, CM delivery). The co-SE cases are AB PCL design-builds.
3. **Don't pitch UHNBC as an open SE seat** — structural is most likely inside DIALOG BC's own scope (no structural alliance participant named; "Engineering" is in their BC entity's legal name). Frame as a capacity-support question. And don't call Prince George seismic-intensive (PGA ≈ Edmonton's).
4. Don't say Vancouver has "only one structural engineer" (≥3) or is "tall-building only" (Broadway Subway, housing) — the accurate gap is **no healthcare structural track record**.
5. **Don't say Oosterhof "chairs" the seismic committee** — he's a voting member of the Standing Committee on Earthquake Design (the chair is Perry Adebar, UBC). Don't call him DIALOG's "only seismic specialist."
6. Don't imply IE 1.5 is new (since ~1990), don't cite a "1% drift limit" for the new check (**0.5%**, Art. 4.1.8.23), don't call the rule Alberta-unique (national since NBC 2020; new to *Alberta* May 1 2024), don't attribute Foothills McCaig structural to Stantec (unverified), don't say UHNBC construction starts "fall 2026" (~2027).

Questions for Georg Josi (July 10)

1. "On **UHNBC** — is your BC team self-performing structural, or is there room for a BC healthcare-structural partner to help carry a \$1.6B tower?"
2. "When a hospital hits Kaye/Calgary-Cancer scale under design-build, how do you structure the co-SE — and who do you reach for?"
3. "Your Vancouver studio's structural strength is towers and transit — how are you covering healthcare structural in BC?"
4. "With the RPK merger and two partners stepping back, where's Edmonton's structural bandwidth tightest over the next 24 months?"

Prerequisites — close before July 10 (only KOR can)

1. **APEGA Permit to Practice** for any Alberta work (hard legal requirement; not needed for BC scope).
2. **Nameable BC hospital / post-disaster references** — the wedge only lands with real projects cited.
3. **An embodied-carbon / LCA story** — the positioning above promises one; have it ready.

Appendix A — Healthcare/institutional structural (verified catalogue)

Project	~Value	Structural	Verdict
Kaye Edmonton Clinic	\$900M	DIALOG + Yolles (now Jacobs), equal partners	Co-SE — AB PCL DB [V]
Calgary Cancer Centre	\$1.4B	DIALOG + Stantec co-SE (PCL DB)	Co-SE — AB PCL DB [V]
Foothills McCaig Tower	—	DIALOG architecture-only; structural = separate firm	External [V]
UHNBC Acute Care Tower	\$1.58B	Publicly unnamed — most likely in-house (DIALOG BC) ; probe	[H — capacity-support angle]
Grande Prairie Regional	~\$680M	In-house (Hildenbrandt, Lenzin)	In-house [V]

Project	~Value	Structural	Verdict
UHN Toronto Western Tower	~\$1B	In-house (Khachi, Ritchie) — CM delivery; breaks any pure scale trigger	In-house [V]
Edson / Gene Zwozdesky / Markdale / Dartmouth	—	In-house (Renihan / — / Khachi / Hildenbrandt cross-deployed)	In-house [V]

Appendix B — Non-healthcare external SE (verified sample)

Project	Sector	Structural	Trigger
Vancouver House (53st)	Tower	Glotman Simpson + BuroHappold	Developer-procured; BIG design lead
Brookfield Place Calgary (60st)	Office	Entuitive	Developer-procured; AFK design lead
The Parks (45+35st) / The Hendrix	Tower	RJC	Developer-procured
The Hive (mass timber)	Office	Fast+Epp	Pioneer seismic timber
Calgary Central Library / TELUS Spark	Civic	Entuitive / Stantec	Design-architect-led
Nk'Mip Cultural Centre	Cultural	Equilibrium	Rammed-earth specialty
Catalyst – 77 Wade	Life sciences	Blackwell	Lab specialty
YYC Int'l Facilities	Aviation	RJC	Architecture-only scope
Shangri-La Van/Tor (62/65st), Pacific Rim	Tower	DIALOG (ex-JKK legacy) as consulting SE — architect was James KM Cheng	SE-only commission, pre-2013-merger
Enbridge Centre (26st)	Office	In-house (Oosterhof)	Only DIALOG-prime + in-house case
Royal Alberta Museum / Winspear / Walterdale / Valley Line / Broadway Subway	Civic/Transit	In-house	Core domains — self-perform

Verification: five research passes and nine rounds of independent fact-checking against primary sources, 2026-06-30/07-01. Corrections made along the way (so you don't repeat them): Shangri-La role attribution (JKK legacy credit, DIALOG was not the architect), UHNBC seat status (most likely in-house), the "\$800M → co-SE" rule narrowed to AB PCL design-builds (UHN Toronto Western is the counterexample), Prince George seismicity (low), Art. 4.1.8.23 precision (0.5% drift, new-to-Alberta), Oosterhof committee role (member, not chair). Sources: dialogdesign.ca, newswire.ca (JKK merger), majorprojects.alberta.ca, infrastructurebc.com, northernhealth.ca, alberta.ca (Part 4 redline), nrcan.gc.ca (seismic hazard), apega.ca, canadianconsultingengineer.com, rjc.ca, fastepp.com, entuitive.com, thortontomasetti.com. [H] items are to test in the room, not assert.